
MEMORANDUM

TO: All Engineering Staff
FROM: Sarah Chen, VP of Engineering
DATE: May 9, 2026
RE: Software Development Process Update
REF: ENG-2026-042
CC: Michael Torres, Director of QA; Lisa Park, Product Manager

1 Background

Over the past quarter, the engineering team has conducted a thorough review of our current software development practices. Feedback from the Q1 retrospective sessions identified several areas where our existing workflow introduces unnecessary friction and delays time-to-market for critical features.

This memo outlines the approved changes to our development process, effective June 1, 2026.

2 Proposed Changes

The following changes have been approved by the engineering leadership team:

- 1. Sprint Duration:** Reduce sprint length from three weeks to two weeks to increase feedback frequency and reduce batch sizes.
- 2. Code Review Policy:** Require at least one approval from a designated code owner for all pull requests merging into the main branch.
- 3. Definition of Done:** Expand the Definition of Done to include automated accessibility checks and performance benchmarks for all user-facing changes.
- 4. Incident Post-Mortems:** Transition to blameless post-mortem reviews with a mandatory 48-hour turnaround for initial drafts.

3 Tooling Updates

The following tools will be adopted or upgraded to support the new process:

Tool	Purpose	Target Date
GitHub Actions	CI/CD pipelines	May 15, 2026
Linear	Issue tracking	May 20, 2026
Datadog APM	Performance monitoring	June 1, 2026
Pa11y	Accessibility testing	June 1, 2026

4 Timeline

May 12 Engineering all-hands to present changes and gather final feedback.

May 15–20 Tool provisioning and account setup.

May 26–30 Training sessions for new tooling (two optional sessions per day).

June 1 New process goes live for all active projects.

June 30 First retrospective under the new process.

5 Action Items

- **Team Leads:** Schedule transition planning meetings with respective squads by May 14.
- **DevOps:** Complete CI/CD pipeline migration by May 20.
- **QA Lead:** Define automated test coverage thresholds for the new Definition of Done by May 16.
- **All Engineers:** Complete tooling onboarding by May 30.

Questions or concerns should be directed to Sarah Chen or your respective team lead by end of day May 14.